

introduction to *Primitive Christianity and its Non-Jewish Sources*, are very sane and very much needed, as is best shown by the multitude of comparisons alleged by first-rate scholars which he rejects. But even among those which he accepts, in a thoroughly tentative way, there are certainly some that are very doubtful. The new method needs much more testing before it will give us assured results.

Before we can begin to examine alleged parallels between Judaism and Parsism, we must obviously ask when and how contacts were made. That the Northern Israelites were deported partly to Media clearly cannot help us: later Judaism owed nothing to the Ten Tribes, whose religious apostasy caused them to vanish out of the history of Israel. What of the Jews in the Babylonian Exile? This question concerns the extent to which they had any real Zoroastrianism around them. During the "Persian period," from the reign of Darius down to the fall of the Achæmenian house, the Jews in Palestine were subject to Zoroastrian kings, as we see elsewhere. The period that follows is very dark. The Arsacide dynasty probably helped Greek influence in Judæa; and our knowledge of the conditions is so limited that we can neither form conclusions of our own nor reject on positive evidence any conjectures that ingenious speculation may attempt. What hap-

Cyrus "trod not the path with his feet"—so he translates, with a reference to Dan. 8⁵. It is to be regarded as a trait of divinity, established as such by the passage in the *Tale of Nala*, familiar to every beginner in Sanskrit, where the four gods at Damayanti's prayer distinguish themselves from their human rival by five tests of which this is one. Possibly Gressmann only means it for illustration.